design, which is the coexistence of a large number of states, including some pre-eminent military powers, all subject to the drive of their special interests and emotions, all subscribing to the theory of sovereignty, and all impelled to develop national power as the instrument of their national policies".

Elements of Statehood

Elements of statehood can be discerned from the definition of state given by
L. Oppenheim (*International Law*, 1905), a British authority on international law. He said that a state "is in existence when a people is settled in a country under its own sovereign government".[5] This definition focuses on the four distinct elements of statehood. They are a people, a territory, a government and the attribute of sovereignty. A careful analysis of all these four elements is necessary.

The People

Most often definition of a state refers to "any body of people occupying a definite territory and politically organized under one government". Therefore, the first vital requirement to qualify as a state, population is important. It is impossible to conceive of a state until and unless people live together in an associated life. This is because state is a form of social organization and people must be its essential component. The number of people who live in a state is a matter of great importance. There is, however, no fixed idea about the exact number of population. Most scholars are of the opinion that what counts is the quality and character of the population. These involve obvious concerns about age, sex distribution, trends in birth rates, standards of living, health, literacy, productive capacity and skills, customs and beliefs, moral standards and morale and national character.

Territory

The second most vital element of statehood is, territory. There can be no state without a fixed territory. Nomadic tribes wandering from